



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Second Baptist School

School Website: <https://www.secondbaptistschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Second Baptist School (SBS) demonstrates a clear Christian, discipleship-centered educational identity with strong religious foundations, a formation-oriented purpose, and a faculty culture that aligns with classical ideals in several respects. The school exhibits robust religious and communal practices (chapel, Bible instruction, prayer, biblical worldview, and Christ-centered mission) that strongly align with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category. It shows a formation-oriented purpose aligned with virtue-dynamic goals, though its explicit classical vocabulary (e.g., Great Books, Great Conversation, liberal arts structure, and explicit Trivium/Quadrivium curricula) is not evident in the public materials; this yields a Somewhat Classical assessment for the School Purpose and Goal category. The Curriculum category largely does not meet classical milestones (no explicit Great Books, no public evidence of Trivium/Quadrivium, etc.), which places SBS in the Not Classical category for that dimension. Pedagogy displays some classical-method elements (memory work, contemplative/restful practice, and liturgical/chapel rhythms) but lacks explicit widespread Socratic seminars or high-school-level rhetoric training across the board, resulting in Somewhat Classical for Pedagogy. The Faculty category shows teachers modeled as living exemplars and as the core of the school (consistent with classical patterns), supporting a Classical rating. Parents & Community reflect strong partnership with families, openness, and community formation, which is supportive of classical aims but does not consistently present a formal, "parents as co-teachers" framework at scale across departments, yielding a Somewhat Classical assessment.

Overall, SBS lands in the realm of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The dominant religious formation and community aspects pull certain categories toward CLASSICAL, but gaps in explicit Great Books-centric curriculum, Trivium/Quadrivium pedagogy, and a universal "parents as co-teachers" framework keep the aggregate from reaching FULL CLASSICAL. The following category-by-category breakdown documents this nuanced assessment and provides concrete steps that would raise SBS toward full CLASSICAL status.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases only)

- Explicitly articulate and integrate the Great Books and Great Conversation framework (even if selectively in certain grades) to evoke the classical curriculum vocabulary and structure.

- Introduce explicit Trivium-focused literacy (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across core grades and provide visible opportunities for students to practice rhetorical writing and Socratic discussion in more classrooms, including upper grades.
- Strengthen the “parents as co-teachers” model with formal programs (parent book studies, liturgical/yearly family formation activities, and clearly defined household/or home-learning alignment) to elevate the Parents & Community category.

ABSTRACT

Second Baptist School presents a hybrid profile: a robust Christian formation program with strong religious and communal practices, coupled with a mission that emphasizes formation, virtue, and leadership. While SBS excels in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and Faculty, and shows Somewhat Classical momentum in Pedagogy and Parents/Community, its public-facing curriculum does not yet demonstrate the full Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium structure required for a CLASSICAL label. The aggregate assessment is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with clear opportunities to enhance Great Books engagement, Trivium-based pedagogy, and deeper parent-education alignment to reach CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- SBS presents a Christ-centered mission: “to equip students to think critically, live biblically and lead courageously” (public materials). This is consistently framed as the core purpose of education at SBS.
- Bible instruction is explicit in lower grades, with daily prayer, scripture memorization, and weekly chapel services, anchoring the school in scriptural truth.
- The Lower School description notes scripture as “the ultimate truth,” reinforcing a transcendent standard for knowledge and formation.
- Visual Arts and other disciplines frame God-centered aims (“God as Creator,” knowledge of God and self) and a biblical worldview across divisions.
- Public mentions of “living biblically,” “capturing students to think critically, live biblically and lead courageously,” and a school-wide emphasis on faith-based formation appear across SBS pages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, theology, liturgy (chapel), worship, wonder, scripture, chapel, God, biblical worldview, faith-based formation. These map to the Positive Keywords in the Classical Lexicon (Element 1) across the SBS materials. For example, “truth” and “scripture as the ultimate truth” appear directly, as do “chapel” and “biblical worldview.”
- Negative keywords: none readily evidenced (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or values-clarification signals observed in public SBS materials). The content leans toward transcendent truth and theological framing.

Why this rating

- SBS clearly grounds education in theological and liturgical practice (Bible instruction, prayer, chapel). The liturgical/communal dimension plus a belief in the objective truth of Scripture align with classical foundations’ religious metaphysical commitments. The presence of a robust Christ-centered mission and liturgical routines indicate CLASSICAL alignment in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence



- The mission emphasizes formation: “think critically, live biblically and lead courageously,” and aims to shape character and leadership within a biblically-centered framework.
- The Lower School description frames a holistic formation: “divinely designed by God with a unique purpose,” nurturing curiosity, biblical perspective, and leadership, with a focus on critical thinking and obedience to biblical principles.
- The public materials frequently emphasize character, faith integration, and a well-rounded formation beyond pure information transfer (e.g., mission statements and building programs).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present (from the Six Essentials list for Element 2): formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, scholé, great conversation, human excellence, moral imagination. Some of these terms appear conceptually (formation, virtue, living biblically, leadership), but explicit classical vocabulary (e.g., “Great Conversation,” “scholé,” “paideia,” “telos”) is not widely used in SBS public materials.
- Negative keywords: none explicitly present in SBS materials (no strong counter-indicators such as “workforce-first,” “career readiness at the expense of formation” in the public-facing text).

Why this rating

- SBS centers education on formation and virtue within a biblically anchored telos, but it does not consistently articulate classical-language aims (e.g., Great Books, Great Conversation) nor the explicit liberal-arts framework. The formation emphasis is strong, but the lack of explicit classical vocabulary and structure results in a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum descriptions emphasize Bible, memory work, and biblical instruction in Lower School, and Christian college-guidance content in Upper School, rather than explicit classical liberal arts structure (grammar/logic/rhetoric) or Great Books programs. Public content highlights biblical integration, mission-based learning, and college preparedness rather than Great Books or the classical canon.
- There is no explicit mention of pursuing the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; quadrivium) or of Great Books/Great Conversation in SBS public materials. The lexicon’s classical curriculum indicators (e.g., Great Books, classical canon) do not appear as SBS public-facing content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords for Element 3 from the Six Essentials lexicon (contains references to Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, etc.). SBS materials do not display these terms; thus positive keyword occurrences are effectively absent in public materials.
- Negative keywords: None explicitly used, but the lack of classical curriculum terminology signals a deviation from classical norms.

Why this rating

- The absence of explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, primary-source canon, or a historically grounded liberal-arts approach places SBS in NOT CLASSICAL for Curriculum. The public materials emphasize biblical integration and Christ-centered learning rather than classical curriculum scaffolding.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Memory work and recitation in Lower School are explicitly mentioned: “daily practices include prayer and scripture memorization.” This aligns with classical pedagogy’s emphasis on memory work and rote learning as a means to form habits and recall (a noted positive in the Classical Lexicon).

- Liturgical and contemplative rhythms (chapel services, spiritual formation) appear as part of the pedagogy, consistent with scholé/restful and contemplative elements in classical education. The Lower School emphasis on biblical instruction and prayer supports contemplative elements.
- Upper School features a focus on thinking critically and leading courageously within a Christ-centered framework, which hints at more advanced, discussion-based and rhetoric-ready skill development, though explicit Socratic seminars or formal rhetoric programs are not documented in public materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present (Element 4): memory work, recitation, contemplation, scholé, wonder (as signs of contemplative and restfulness), liturgy/chapel-integrated practices.
- Negative keywords present: not strongly evidenced. The public materials do not show an overemphasis on purely experiential, project-based pedagogy to the exclusion of memory-based learning; but there is limited explicit mention of Socratic seminars or formal rhetoric pedagogy across all grades.

Why this rating

- SBS shows classical-method signals (memory work, contemplative rhythms, liturgical incorporation), but it lacks explicit, widespread Socratic pedagogy and a full rhetoric-based, upper-school seminar culture across the board. The emphasis tilts toward classical aspects in some grades, but the overall pedagogy does not consistently meet all strong classical pedagogy criteria, yielding SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Faculty are described as model teachers and mentors who love God, love students, and pursue excellence in their craft; the living curriculum concept is reflected in public materials (faculty as core and exemplar). This aligns with classical education's emphasis on virtuous, skilled, and trusted mentors shaping the learning experience.
- The school environment emphasizes the "portrait of a teacher" and "faculty as the living curriculum," consistent with classical formation principles (teachers as exemplars and living curriculum). Public materials include examples of teachers and faculty recognition (e.g., faculty features and department pages).
- SBS presents a mentoring and leadership culture (e.g., upper-school leaders, prefects, fellows) that aligns with the classical idea of skilled, virtuous faculty guiding students.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty as mentors; □□ as exemplars; collegial culture; moral exemplars; leadership development.
- Negative keywords: none observed in public materials (no "facilitators" or non-classical staff descriptors).

Why this rating

- SBS presents a clear, classical-oriented faculty posture: teachers are central, exemplars, and mentors who shape both content and character. This aligns with CLASSICAL in Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- SBS emphasizes partnership with families as a central feature: "partnership between families and the school, working together to encourage students to become ambassadors for Christ," and a broad focus on community-building and hospitality. This signals a classical emphasis on parental involvement in formation.

- The school communicates to parents and communities through book studies, gatherings, and family formation opportunities (e.g., “Discover SBS,” “Welcome to SBS,” and various parent-facing updates), indicating a family-formation orientation.
- There are clear indicators of community identity (awareness-building through news, Eagle magazines, and testimonies about strong community of faith), implying a welcoming environment for parental involvement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present (Element 6): partnership with parents; parent formation; open campus/hospitality; family liturgy alignment (implicit in biblically-centered programming); parent involvement in school life.
- Negative keywords: consumer-language signals or minimal parent involvement are not evident; however, the explicit formal “parents as co-teachers” framework is not uniformly documented across all SBS pages, limiting full CLASSICAL status in this category.

Why this rating

- SBS demonstrates solid parental engagement and community orientation, with partnerships and family formation initiatives. However, the evidence for a formal, scalable “parents as co-teachers” model across the entire school is less explicit, placing Element 6 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Explicitly adopt and publicize a Great Books/Great Conversation component within core curriculum, including a school-wide or grade-structured reading list and discussions that align with classical canon and Western philosophical/historic intellectual tradition.
- Introduce and publicly document a formal Trivium-based pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across more grade levels, with explicit opportunities for students to practice logical argumentation, structured writing, and public speaking in both lower and upper grades.
- Elevate the explicit role of parents as co-teachers by providing structured, ongoing programs (parent seminars/book clubs, home-learning guides aligned with classical aims) and formal visitation/participation models in classrooms and school life.
- Ensure public materials consistently articulate the six-element classical framework (including Great Books, scholé/restful learning, and dialogic pedagogy) to strengthen the curriculum and pedagogy categories toward CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.